

WEEK 4 LESSON OUTLINE

**STICK
TOGETHER**

BIG IDEA

You'll always have a friend in Jesus.

BIBLE

Proverbs 18:24; John 15:13–16, 18:2–27; Psalm 113:4–8

ABOUT THIS WEEK

Great adventure stories tell about friends who have each other's backs and stick together no matter what. This week, we'll see how Jesus calls us to love others the way he loves us and how God's faithfulness is the ultimate example of an unshakable friend. Jesus chose us to be his friends, and that means no matter what, **you'll always have a friend in Jesus!**

WHAT?

In adventure movies, there's usually some kind of friend who shows up and helps our hero complete their quest or escape danger. But sometimes in these stories, we also get to see what it's like for a character to not have anyone to turn to at all.

We know what it's like when it feels like no one is there for us. It hurts to feel alone, invisible, or abandoned. It's not always easy to know what to do or who to turn to when we feel that way. Don't we all want at least one friend who never leaves or lets you down?

SO WHAT?

Proverbs 18:24 speaks of someone who will "stick" with us, when all the usual support falls apart and we feel alone. And even though the verse doesn't say it, that someone is Jesus.

In John 18:2–27, Jesus is abandoned by not one but two of his closest friends—Judas and Peter. But Jesus stays faithful even when his friends don't. Hours before this turn of events, Jesus wanted his followers to know in John 15:13–16 that he loved them and would always be with them.

Jesus is the kind of friend who sticks with you, even when things fall apart. **You'll always have a friend in Jesus.**

NOW WHAT?

Just like any other friendship, your friendship with Jesus will grow when you invest in it. How?

- **TALK TO JESUS:** That's right—Just talk to him. Get to know him. Show him the real you.
- **SPEND TIME WITH JESUS:** Read about Jesus in the Gospels. You'll see he's kind, patient, and available.
- **BE A GOOD FRIEND:** Be the kind of friend Jesus is to you. How can you reflect that back to him? How can you reflect that back to others?

When everyone else lets you down, remember **you'll always have a friend in Jesus.**